

LAST VALUATION \$1.3B Jan 2026	REVENUE RUN-RATE ~\$300M est.	REGISTERED USERS 15M+ Jan 2026
PAYING USERS ~300K Jan 2026	TOTAL RAISED \$138M	

BUSINESS OVERVIEW

PLAIN ENGLISH

- An AI video app: type a prompt or drop a product link, get a cinematic clip in seconds.
- Used mostly for social-media ads and short-form content.
- Customers are marketers, agencies and creators, not classic enterprise-software buyers.

THE TECHNICAL VERSION

- Not a foundation-model lab; an orchestration layer on top of other models.
- Uses LLMs (GPT-4.1 and GPT-5) to plan shots, pacing and camera moves.
- Routes rendering to the best third-party model (OpenAI Sora 2, Google Veo, Kling, Seedance).
- Adds its own controls: 50+ camera presets, motion control, and Soul ID character consistency.
- Monetizes through credits, subscriptions and enterprise contracts.

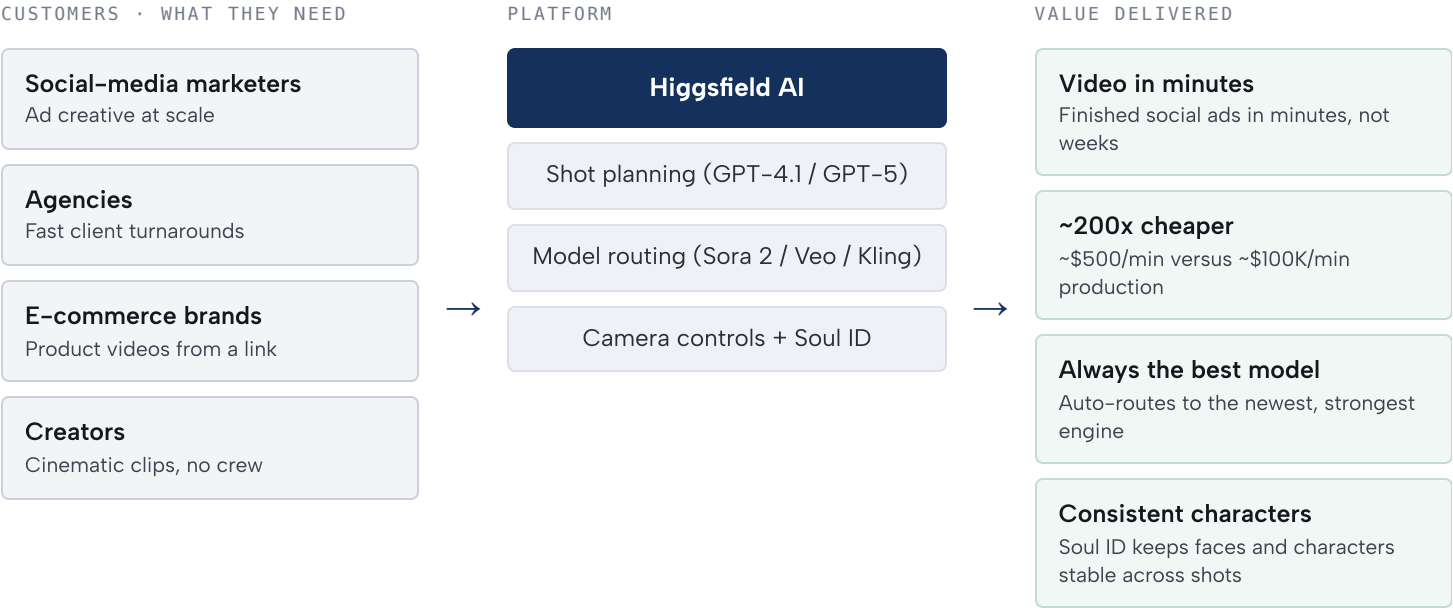
EXPLAINED SIMPLY

- Like a really good video editor that does not own a camera.
- OpenAI, Google and Kuaishou built the cameras (the AI models that make the video).
- Higgsfield's trick is picking the right one per shot, directing it, and stitching a polished ad in minutes.
- A marketer types a few words and gets a usable ad for a few dollars, not weeks and \$100,000.

- Higgsfield is an AI video platform: type a prompt or drop a product link, get a cinematic social-ad clip in seconds.
- Founded 2023 in San Francisco by ex-Snap GenAI head Alex Mashrabov; ~\$138M raised, last valued at \$1.3B (Jan 2026).
- It is an orchestration layer, not a model lab: it routes to Sora 2, Veo, Kling and Seedance, then adds camera controls and Soul ID consistency.

- Traction is explosive: 15M+ users, ~300K paying, 4.5M generations per day, and a Sacra-estimated ~\$300M run-rate (a projection, not recognized revenue).
- About 85% of usage is social-media marketers; enterprise clients (Coca-Cola and Nike cited) can spend \$200K+ per year.
- Monetizes via credits, subscriptions and enterprise/team plans; the pitch is replacing ~\$100K/min production with ~\$500/min AI output.
- Backers include Accel, Menlo Ventures and GFT Ventures; the CEO targets a \$1B run-rate by end of 2026.
- Central debate: defensibility as a layer on top of third-party models, plus brand-safety and IP controversies that surfaced in early 2026.

How the business works, left to right: who buys, what the platform provides, and the payoff.



HOW HIGGSFIELD IS DIFFERENT

PLAYER	WHAT THEY MAKE	HOW HIGGSFIELD DIFFERS
OpenAI Sora / Google Veo	The underlying foundation video models	Higgsfield does not compete on raw model quality; it sits on top and routes to them, betting that workflow, control and distribution matter more than owning the model. The flip side: its suppliers can also become its competitors.

PLAYER	WHAT THEY MAKE	HOW HIGGSFIELD DIFFERS
Runway (RUNWY, private)	Its own video models plus a pro editing suite	The most-capitalized pure-play at \$5.3B and a real research lab. Higgsfield is far smaller and model-agnostic, racing on consumer virality and price rather than in-house model research.
Kling (Kuaishou)	A frontier video model from a Chinese social giant	One of Higgsfield's rendering options, not a workflow rival. It supplies capability that Higgsfield repackages with controls and distribution.
Synthesia / HeyGen	AI avatar and talking-head video for corporate use	They target training, sales and corporate comms. Higgsfield targets cinematic social and ad creative, a different format and a different buyer.
Pika / Luma	Their own consumer video models	Well-funded model builders. Higgsfield's edge is the orchestration layer and viral distribution, not raw model research.

EXECUTIVE LEADERSHIP

CO-FOUNDER & CEO SINCE 2023 Alex Mashrabov Former Head of Generative AI at Snap (built Snap Lenses); joined Snap after it acquired his startup AI Factory for \$166M in 2020.	CO-FOUNDER & CTO SINCE 2023 Yerzat Dulat Open-source ML researcher and author of popular GitHub libraries; met Mashrabov via international science olympiads.	CO-FOUNDER & CHIEF STRATEGY OFFICER SINCE 2023 Mahi de Silva Veteran executive with leadership roles at Triller, Amplify and Verisign; earlier a senior engineer at Apple.
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PRODUCT & REVENUE MODEL

- Higgsfield monetizes a consumption-based credit system plus monthly subscriptions and enterprise/team contracts.
- Users generate cinematic clips from text, images or product links; the platform plans shots with GPT-4.1/GPT-5 and renders via third-party models (Sora 2, Veo, Kling, Seedance), adding proprietary camera controls and Soul ID character consistency.
- The wedge is professional social-media ad creative, with a pitch of replacing roughly \$100K/min production with about \$500/min AI output.

RECENT NEWS

2026-05-21

Higgsfield debuts 95-minute AI feature film Hell Grind around Cannes

SOURCE: SCREEN INTERNATIONAL

Signals a push up-market into long-form film (a far larger TAM), but Cannes said the film was not in its official program, an early credibility risk if prestige milestones are over-marketed.

2026-04-10

Higgsfield launches crowdsourced AI TV pilot and Original Series

SOURCE: PR NEWswire

An owned content and distribution play that could build a recurring IP layer beyond commodity model access; the new AI Likeness Licensing framework is an early answer to deepfake criticism.

2026-02-26

Higgsfield ships Cinema Studio 2.0 filmmaking suite at ~\$20

SOURCE: PR NEWswire

Aggressive low pricing on a pro suite is a land-grab against Runway, Veo and Sora and reinforces a marketer-led go-to-market, supportive of volume but pressuring gross margin given third-party compute costs.

2026-02-11

Higgsfield X account suspended for inauthentic behavior; CEO responds

SOURCE: FORBES

Losing its primary growth-marketing channel hits the top-of-funnel engine behind its user and run-rate growth, a real execution and brand risk.

2026-02-09

Forbes expose details racist marketing videos and payment disputes

SOURCE: FORBES

Reputational, brand-safety and potential right-of-publicity and false-advertising exposure that could deter enterprise and brand customers and weigh on valuation despite hypergrowth. Forbes editorial date approximate (mid-Feb 2026).

2026-02-01

Sacra estimates Higgsfield at roughly \$300M annualized run-rate

SOURCE: SACRA

Triple-digit-million run-rate inside a year underpins the \$1.3B mark (~4x to 6x run-rate), but heavy concentration in one buyer segment and reliance on viral marketing raise questions on retention and durability. Month-level date.

2026-01-15

Higgsfield raises \$80M Series A extension at \$1.3B valuation

SOURCE: TECHCRUNCH

Unicorn status under two years from founding with top-tier backers (Accel, Menlo) validates the category and sets a clear valuation anchor.

- 2025-09-09

Higgsfield raises \$50M Series A at \$1B valuation

SOURCE: PR NEWSWIRE

First unicorn mark establishes the prior valuation step (\$1.0B to \$1.3B in about four months) and the click-to-video-for-social wedge against Runway and the foundation-model incumbents.
- 2025-06-25

Higgsfield Soul image model goes viral

SOURCE: BGR

Soul was the viral catalyst behind the user and revenue surge, demonstrating the consumer-virality flywheel that distinguishes Higgsfield from enterprise-led video rivals.

FINANCIALS & KEY METRICS

Traction and metrics · as of Feb 2026

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GENERATIONS / DAY 4.5M per day	IMPRESSIONS 4.5B+ cumulative		

- AI / Product:** Higgsfield's vision is an end-to-end AI video platform that abstracts away model choice. CEO Alex Mashrabov: 'We orchestrate the entire workflow.'
- Demand:** Demand is led by enterprise marketing teams for social ad creative. Mashrabov cites customers with marketing budgets over \$100 million turning 90% of their social ad creative to AI, framing the value as cutting cost from ~\$100,000 to ~\$500 per minute.

KEY RISKS & DEBATES

- Model dependency:** Higgsfield orchestrates third-party models, so a supplier (OpenAI, Google, Kuaishou) can cut access or compete directly; Sora routing was already disrupted once.
- Revenue quality:** the ~\$200M to \$300M run-rate is a company and Sacra estimate and a projection, not recognized revenue (Axios Pro flagged this).
- Brand-safety and legal:** a Forbes expose alleged racist marketing clips and nonconsensual deepfakes, creating right-of-publicity and false-advertising exposure that could deter enterprise buyers.
- Channel risk:** the X account was suspended in Feb 2026 for inauthentic behavior, hitting the viral engine behind growth.

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Concentration: about 85% of usage is one buyer segment (social marketers), so retention and durability are unproven.
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Competition and capital: rivals are far better funded (Runway \$5.3B, Luma \$4B, Synthesia \$4B) and several own their models.
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Valuation: \$1.3B on an estimated run-rate leaves little room for error if growth or retention disappoints.

COMPARABLE COMPANIES

COMPANY	CATEGORY	LAST VALUATION	LAST RAISE	NOTE
Higgsfield AI	AI video (orchestration)	\$1.3B	\$80M ext. (Jan 2026)	Subject. ~\$300M est. run-rate, 15M users; layer on top of third-party models
Runway	Models + tools	\$5.3B	\$315M Series E (Feb 2026)	Best-capitalized pure-play; builds its own models
Synthesia	AI avatars	\$4B	\$200M Series E (Jan 2026)	Corporate/training talking-head video; different format
Luma AI	Foundation model	\$4B	\$900M Series C (Nov 2025)	Dream Machine; HUMAIN (Saudi) backed
Pika Labs	Consumer video	\$700M	\$80M Series B (Jun 2024)	Earlier-stage consumer model
HeyGen	AI avatars	\$500M	\$60M Jun 2024	Avatar/spokesperson video; later round unconfirmed

SOURCES: Private valuations and rounds from the cited reporting (TechCrunch, Bloomberg, CNBC, Sacra, PitchBook). These are last-round marks, not market prices, and the dates differ by company.

FUNDING HISTORY



Total raised: \$138M

NOTABLE INVESTORS

Accel

Menlo Ventures

GFT Ventures

AI Capital Partners

NextEquity

IPO READINESS

- Early-stage, multiple years out.
 - Positives: explosive growth, top-tier syndicate (Accel, Menlo, GFT), 15M+ users, a \$1B run-rate target for end-2026.
 - Cautions: only Series A, \$138M raised, run-rate is a projection rather than recognized revenue, and far-better-capitalized peers.
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SLIDE-READY BULLETS

- 1 Higgsfield is an AI-video orchestration layer (routes to Sora 2, Veo, Kling), not a foundation-model lab; founded 2023, \$1.3B valuation (Jan 2026).
 - 2 Hypergrowth: 15M+ users, ~300K paying, 4.5M generations per day; Sacra-estimated ~\$300M run-rate (a projection), targeting \$1B by end-2026.
 - 3 Marketer-led wedge: ~85% social-media marketers; enterprise (Coca-Cola, Nike cited) at \$200K+/year; ~\$100K/min to ~\$500/min cost pitch.
 - 4 Backed by Accel, Menlo and GFT; ~\$138M raised across a seed plus \$50M and \$80M Series A rounds.
 - 5 Core debate: defensibility on top of third-party models, plus early-2026 brand-safety, IP and channel-suspension controversies.
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SMART DILIGENCE QUESTIONS

- Q1 How much revenue is recognized versus run-rate or estimated, what are net retention and gross margin after third-party model-compute costs, and how concentrated is usage in social-media marketers?
 - Q2 What contractual access and pricing does Higgsfield have to the models it depends on (Sora 2, Veo, Kling), and what is the plan if a supplier restricts access or competes directly?
 - Q3 What is the legal and brand exposure from the deepfake and content-moderation issues, and what controls and licensing (e.g. the AI Likeness Licensing framework) are now in place?
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SLIDE KIT

Logo, stats, and copy-paste artifacts

Higgsfield AI

SERIES A (EXTENDED)

higgsfield.ai

AI Video

Generative AI

Creator / MarTech

COPY-PASTE STATS

\$138M total raised

TOP 3 SLIDE BULLETS

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- Marketer-led wedge: ~85% social-media marketers; enterprise (Coca-Cola, Nike cited) at \$200K+/year; ~\$100K/min to ~\$500/min cost pitch.

BRAND COLORS

#D1FE17

#FF005B

#E72930

#1886F5

#4FCEE4

BRAND TAGS

AI Video

Generative AI

Creator / MarTech